

He walks like someone who knows he's being watched – not nervously, not proudly. Just... aware. There's a rhythm to his movements, like every gesture was rehearsed for a slightly different audience than the one he's actually performing for.

He says hello to everyone. Every single person. By name. And they love him for it.

But I've watched him forget names when he thinks no one's paying attention. He repeats them under his breath before he greets someone. Once, I saw him check a notebook before he entered the cafeteria. A list.

Who keeps a list of people they like?

I don't think it's about liking anyone.
I think it's about being liked.

Temporary label: R-1
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